EXAMPLE DATA — FICTIONAL TEST DOCUMENT FOR BATATIS USER TESTING — NOT A REAL PROJECT

Project Brief — Backyard Garden Suite (Hempcrete)

Prepared by: Dana Hartley (owner / builder) **Date:** 2026-10-14

Site: 0000 Example Avenue NW, Edmonton, AB (fictional address) **Legal description:** *don't have it yet — will ask the city* (fictional)
Permit #: not applied for yet

What I want to build

A small one-bedroom garden suite at the back of my lot for my mother. About 60 m² main floor, with a sleeping loft over the bathroom. I *think* that makes it under 3 storeys, but I'm not sure how lofts are counted.

The unusual part

Instead of a normal 2x6 stud wall with batt insulation and poly, I want 300 mm cast-in-place hempcrete around a timber frame (2x4 at 600 mm o.c. buried in the hempcrete), finished with lime render outside and lime plaster inside. No poly vapour barrier — the supplier says hempcrete needs to "breathe".

- Roof: conventional trusses, blown cellulose, standard shingles
- Foundation: insulated slab on grade
- Heating: one ductless heat pump + electric baseboard backup
- Distance to house: about 4 m; to back lane fence: about 1.5 m

What I have

- Supplier brochure "HempWall Pro" (fictional) claiming R-2.0 per inch and "excellent fire resistance"
- Photos of a similar build in BC
- No lab tests, no engineer yet

Questions

Do I need a variance? What do I have to give the city? Can I do this without hiring an engineer?